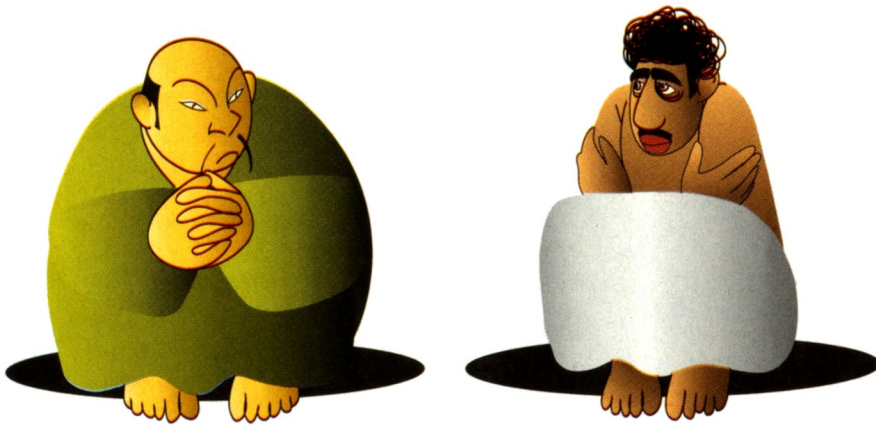


INDIA IN DIVERSITY

Numbers once again illustrate the extremely diversified status of Indian states



Andamans have more policemen per resident (561 per lakh) than J&K (424 per lakh).



Illustrations by SAURABH SINGH

Inequality levels in China are higher than in any state of India. Kerala and Maharashtra have the highest inequality among the large states. Assam has the lowest.

Delhi has more than thrice the number of kidnappings (1,590) than it has murders (455). Madhya Pradesh has almost thrice the number of murders (2,405) than it has kidnappings (847).

An average graduate now earns 8.3 times as much as an illiterate wage and salary earner. In the early '90s, this was 6.5 times.

Income inequality among wage and salary earners in India is higher than the overall inequality in 108 out of 123 countries.

Among big states, only Punjab, J&K and Himachal Pradesh have less than 10 per cent of their population below poverty line.



Household owning TV Sets			
Top five		Bottom five	
Delhi	85.37	Chhattisgarh	27.61
Chandigarh	84.71	Meghalaya	27.12
Punjab	78.08	Orissa	24.01
Goa	75.73	Jharkhand	23.94
Puducherry	71.99	Bihar	14.97

Figures in percentage